

Bank of Leeds Strategic Tourism & Leisure Investment Proposal

Flamingo Land 2050 Expansion Programme

Transforming Flamingo Land into Britain's Largest Integrated Resort Destination

Prepared for:

Bank of Leeds

Department of Tourism, Hospitality & Strategic Investment

Investment Classification:

Tourism • Hospitality • Commercial Property • Transport • Leisure Infrastructure

Proposed Investment Vehicle:

Yorkshire Leisure Development Corporation (YLDC)

Indicative Capital Programme

£2.75 Billion

Delivery Period

2032–2045

Executive Summary

By 2031, Yorkshire has become one of Britain's strongest regional economies. The Bank of Leeds proposes transforming **Flamingo Land Resort**, already one of the UK's largest privately owned theme parks, zoos and holiday villages, into a genuine multi-day international destination resort. Flamingo Land attracted more than **1.5 million visitors** before the pandemic and remains one of northern England's leading visitor attractions.

The proposal is not simply to add more rollercoasters.

Instead, it creates:

Britain's largest integrated leisure resort

combining:

- a world-class theme park,
 - an expanded wildlife park,
 - luxury hotels,
 - an indoor water park,
 - conference facilities,
 - a rail connection,
 - retail,
 - entertainment,
 - holiday villages,
 - and a new "Yorkshire Adventure District."
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Strategic Vision

Flamingo Land becomes:

Yorkshire Resort

rather than simply:

Theme Park + Zoo.

The ambition is to compete with:

- Europa-Park (Germany)
- Efteling (Netherlands)
- PortAventura (Spain)

while offering a uniquely Yorkshire identity.

Total Investment

Programme	Investment
Theme park expansion	£700m
Hotels & lodges	£500m
Indoor waterpark	£300m
Zoo expansion	£250m
Retail village	£200m
Railway & transport	£300m
Conference centre	£150m
Property development	£200m
Renewable energy	£100m
Contingency	£50m

Total

£2.75 Billion

1. New Theme Park Lands

Investment:

£700 million

Construct four entirely new themed lands over approximately a decade.

Examples include:

Yorkshire Legends

Historic Yorkshire-inspired rides and immersive storytelling.

Future Britain

A science-fiction themed zone featuring next-generation attractions.

Lost Kingdom

Large-scale family adventure attractions.

Ocean Expedition

A waterfront district with restaurants and indoor attractions.

The aim is to encourage visitors to spend multiple days on site rather than making a single-day visit.

2. Yorkshire Safari Expansion

Investment

£250 million

Expand the zoological park with larger naturalistic habitats.

Potential additions:

- African savannah expansion
- Asian rainforest
- Arctic zone
- conservation centre

- veterinary research facilities

Comparable expansion projects elsewhere in Yorkshire have shown that major investment in visitor facilities and animal habitats can substantially increase attendance. For example, the Yorkshire Wildlife Park expansion aims to increase annual visitors from around **760,000 to 1.5 million**.

3. Yorkshire Water Resort

Investment

£300 million

Construct Britain's largest indoor waterpark.

Facilities include:

- wave pool,
- indoor beach,
- surf simulator,
- family slides,
- spa,
- wellness centre,
- thermal pools.

Operating throughout the year, the attraction reduces dependence on summer weather.

4. Resort Hotels

Investment

£500 million

Develop three new hotels.

Hotel	Rooms
Grand Flamingo Hotel	400
Safari Lodge Resort	300
Woodland Spa Hotel	250

Additional accommodation:

- 600 luxury lodges,
 - lakeside cabins,
 - premium camping.
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5. Yorkshire Village

Investment

£200 million

A pedestrian retail and restaurant district featuring:

- Yorkshire breweries,
- gin distillery,
- artisan bakeries,
- confectionery,
- farm shops,
- independent retailers.

This extends visitor activity into the evening.

6. Railway Connection

Investment

£300 million

The proposal recommends reopening or constructing a dedicated rail connection from **Malton** to Flamingo Land, with integrated shuttle services into the resort. The park is currently served mainly by road and connecting buses from Malton station.

Journey targets:

Route	Current	Target
York → Flamingo Land	~60 min	35 min
Leeds → Flamingo Land	~2 hrs	75 min
Scarborough → Flamingo Land	~75 min	40 min

This railway also supports tourism across the wider Ryedale area.

7. Conference & Events Centre

Investment

£150 million

Facilities:

- 5,000-seat conference hall,

- exhibition centre,
- corporate event space,
- banquet facilities.

The objective is to generate year-round business demand.

Property Investment

The Bank of Leeds establishes:

Yorkshire Leisure Property Fund

Initial Capital

£200 million

Acquire strategic land around the resort before development.

Potential developments:

- hotels,
 - holiday homes,
 - retirement villages,
 - restaurants,
 - service businesses.
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Visitor Forecast

Year	Visitors
Current baseline	~1.5 million
Phase One	2.5 million
Phase Two	4 million
Mature Resort	5 million

The increase is driven by longer stays, expanded accommodation and all-weather attractions rather than by theme park rides alone.

Financial Model

Revenue Source	Annual Revenue
Theme park	£220m
Hotels	£180m

Revenue Source	Annual Revenue
Waterpark	£90m
Zoo	£80m
Food & beverage	£130m
Retail	£90m
Conferences	£60m

Total Annual Revenue

Approximately £850 million

Operating costs:

Approximately

£520 million

Estimated EBITDA:

£330 million annually

Employment

Construction:

Approximately

25,000 job-years

Permanent employment:

Sector	Jobs
Hospitality	3,000
Theme park	2,000
Zoo	800
Hotels	1,800
Retail	1,200
Conferences	500
Total permanent jobs:	

Approximately 9,300

Wider Yorkshire Impact

The expanded resort strengthens:

- York,
- Malton,
- Pickering,
- Scarborough,
- North York Moors tourism.

Visitors are encouraged to purchase combined packages including:

- Flamingo Land,
 - York,
 - Scarborough,
 - the North Yorkshire Moors Railway,
 - Castle Howard,
 - the Yorkshire coast.
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Financing

Yorkshire Leisure Bond

Issue Size

£2.75 Billion

Source	Amount
Bank of Leeds	£1.0bn
Pension funds	£700m
Private hospitality investors	£600m
Institutional investors	£450m

Final Investment Thesis

The Bank of Leeds views Flamingo Land not simply as an amusement park, but as the nucleus of a broader **North Yorkshire Tourism Corridor**.

By integrating transport improvements, accommodation, hospitality, wildlife conservation, conference facilities and commercial property development, the resort becomes a destination capable of supporting multi-day stays and attracting visitors throughout the year.

The long-term ambition is not merely to create a larger theme park, but to establish **Yorkshire's flagship leisure resort**, generating sustained private investment, supporting regional tourism businesses and reinforcing Yorkshire's position as one of the UK's leading visitor economies.

